

Goa Goings on!

"WHAT in the world is that?" Chintu asked his father, his ears still **straining** to catch the continuous **roar**.

"A train?" his sister Tina suggested a bit doubtfully, **wondering** if any train could go on for such a long time. For the past 10 minutes the noise had been **accompanying** them as they walked slowly along the narrow road leading to the beach.

Their parents exchanged a smile but the answer was **irritatingly cryptic**, "Wait and see!"

And when they finally came to the origin of the sound, they **gaped**! The **ceaseless** sound was being produced by the majestic waves crashing **relentlessly** on the rocky beach. The beauty of the beach **took their breath away** and even 'Chatterbox Chintu' **fell silent**. But, not for long!

"Oooh! Wow! Look at that!" He was **squealing** the next minute, pointing at a water-scooter zipping across the ocean. And of course everybody guessed his next words,

"When are we going to do that?"

And soon, all of them were **bundled in** life-belts and **heading gingerly** along the wet sand to where the scooterwallas waited.

How they LOVED it! The salty spray on their faces and the **magnificent** speed of the scooters were **thrilling** beyond words. So much so, that Chintu was soon imagining himself as the **dashing** James Bond! In spite of the strict instructions by the scooter driver, he left the **bar** and **waved out** to his imaginary fans. It was his **misfortune** that the scooter took a rather sharp turn that very minute and the next, Chintu found himself in the sea, **spluttering** and coughing!

"Serves you right!" **hissed** the scooterwala, **dragging him out** by the **scruff** of his neck, "What did you think you were doing?"

"Hi there, Hero!" **shouted** two **raucous** voices from behind and spraying Chintu once again with sea water, a scooter **zipped by**. Chintu just **caught sight of** two men on it **grinning from ear to ear**.

And since then, Chintu and Tina noticed, much to their concern, that wherever they went, those two men also appeared, though they never said anything apart from an embarrassing 'Hi, Hero' to Chintu. With the hundreds of kidnapping stories **buzzing** in his mind, Chintu started **watching out** for them before reporting anything to their parents. He became really worried when he found that the men had installed themselves in their hotel. And when he caught them taking his and Tina's pictures, it was absolutely **the last straw**.



However, our Chintu hadn't watched all those detective serials for nothing. It was a matter of two days when he had a perfect plan **in place** to **nab** the villains. They were dealing with him, Chintu! Hah!

Though his parents **frowned upon** it, it was his friendship with the hotel staff that made the plan possible. The **sturdy** two bellboys, the housekeeper, Chintu and Tina **crept** one early morning to Room 420, where the villains were staying. The bellboys rang the bell, holding up the tea-tray in the line of the magic-eye.

The moment the men **groggily** opened the door, all five rushed in and within minutes had the **stupefied duo** **trussed up** like chickens!

"What ... what...what is the meaning of this?" said one of them angrily.

"I'll tell you," **thundered** the **victorious** Chintu. "You were planning to kidnap us, weren't you?"

"WHAT?" the taller man **gasp**ed, and then, much to the **amazement** of everybody, the two started rolling with laughter!!!

When they had finally finished, they asked Chintu to open a black briefcase and take out their ID cards and driving licences.

"As you can see, we are talent **scouts** for Amazing Advertisements," explained Vinod Pradhan, the tall man. "The two of you appeared perfect for a children's health drink and we wanted them to look natural in the sample pictures we were sending to our clients, hence the **secrecy** in photographing them."

"How could we have known that we had a real James Bond here?" said the **bald** one, smiling broadly. Chintu could only smile back **sheepishly**.

"So, shall we talk to your parents and **draw up** the contract?" Baldy asked **courteously**.

Could they?!!!!

So, now when you see this naughty looking boy on TV with his sensible looking sister, you'll know who they are—Chintu and Tina, of course!!



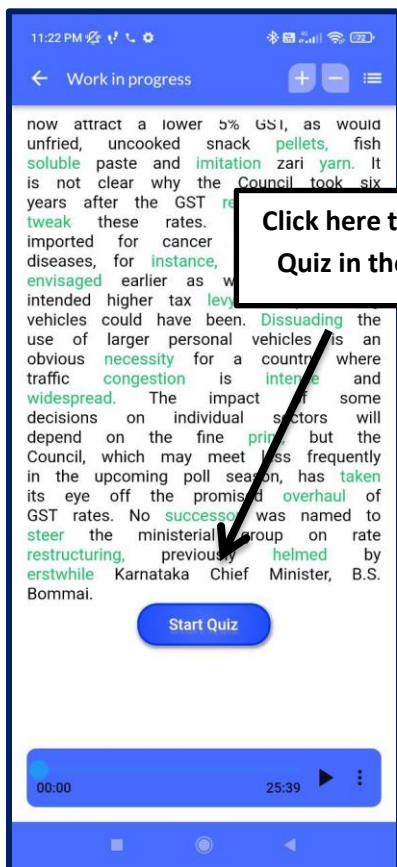
Vocabulary

1. **Strain** (verb) – exert, stretch, overuse, stress, struggle – ज़ोर लगाना
2. **Roar** (noun) – rumble, thunder, boom, noise, growl – गड़गड़ाहट
3. **Wonder** (verb) – ponder, think, speculate, question, marvel – आश्चर्य करना / सोचना
4. **Accompany** (verb) – go with, join, escort, attend, follow – साथ जाना
5. **Irritatingly** (adverb) – annoyingly, exasperatingly, vexingly, frustratingly, provokingly – चिड़चिड़ेपन से
6. **Cryptic** (adjective) – mysterious, vague, obscure, puzzling, enigmatic – रहस्यमय
7. **Gape** (verb) – stare, gawk, gaze, ogle, look in awe – हैरानी से देखना
8. **Ceaseless** (adjective) – continuous, unending, endless, nonstop, relentless – निरंतर
9. **Relentlessly** (adverb) – persistently, unyieldingly, constantly, continuously, unceasingly – बेरोकटोक
10. **Take one's breath away** (phrase) – amaze, astonish, overwhelm, impress, stun – मंत्रमुग्ध कर देना
11. **Chatterbox** (noun) – talkative person, blabbermouth, chatterer, babbler, gabbler – बातूनी
12. **Fall silent** (phrase) – stop talking, become quiet, hush, go silent, pause – चुप हो जाना
13. **Squeal** (verb) – shriek, scream, squeak, yelp, cry out – चीखना / चिल्लाना
14. **Bundle in** (phrasal verb) – pack together, load, wrap, cluster, group – लपेटना / समूह में जाना
15. **Head (along)** (verb) – go towards, proceed, move, advance, walk – की ओर बढ़ना
16. **Gingerly** (adverb) – cautiously, carefully, delicately, warily, tentatively – सतर्कता से
17. **Magnificent** (adjective) – splendid, grand, majestic, impressive, glorious – शानदार
18. **Thrill** (verb) – excite, exhilarate, electrify, stir, stimulate – रोमांचित करना
19. **Dashing** (adjective) – stylish, charming, attractive, spirited, gallant – आकर्षक / सजीला
20. **Bar** (noun) – handle, rod, pole, lever, railing – पकड़ने का डंडा
21. **Wave out** (phrasal verb) – signal, gesture, greet, acknowledge, beckon – हाथ हिलाकर अभिवादन करना
22. **Misfortune** (noun) – bad luck, mishap, adversity, accident, setback – दुर्भाग्य

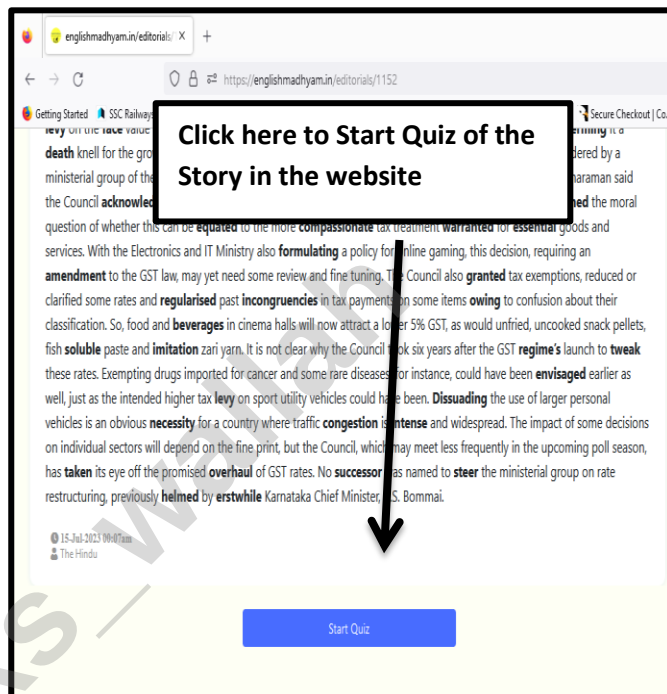
23. **Sputtering** (noun) – choking, gasping, coughing, stammering, spitting – खांसना / हांफना
24. **Hiss** (verb) – whisper sharply, sizzle, spit, snarl, speak angrily – फुफकारना
25. **Drag out** (phrasal verb) – pull out, yank, haul, tug, extract – बाहर खींचना
26. **Scruff** (noun) – back of the neck, nape, collar, neck-hold, grip – गरदन का पिछला भाग
27. **Shout** (verb) – yell, scream, call, cry, exclaim – चिल्लाना
28. **Raucous** (adjective) – loud, noisy, boisterous, rowdy, harsh – कर्कश
29. **Zip by** (phrasal verb) – rush past, speed by, whiz past, zoom by, race – तेजी से गुजरना
30. **Caught sight of** (phrase) – glimpse, notice, spot, see briefly, detect – एक झलक पाना
31. **Grin from ear to ear** (phrase) – smile widely, beam, smirk, laugh openly, show delight – कान से कान तक मुस्कुराना
32. **Buzz** (verb) – hum, murmur, chatter, vibrate, whisper – भनभनाना / चर्चा करना
33. **Watch out** (phrasal verb) – be careful, beware, look out, take care, stay alert – सतर्क रहना
34. **The last straw** (phrase) – final insult, breaking point, last insult, tipping point, unbearable act – सहनशक्ति की सीमा
35. **In place** (phrase) – ready, arranged, set, fixed, prepared – तैयार / यथास्थान
36. **Nab** (verb) – catch, seize, arrest, capture, apprehend – पकड़ना
37. **Frown upon** (phrasal verb) – disapprove, reject, look down on, condemn, criticize – नापसंद करना
38. **Sturdy** (adjective) – strong, solid, robust, tough, well-built – मजबूत
39. **Creep** (verb) – crawl, sneak, tiptoe, slink, move quietly – धीरे से चलना
40. **Groggily** (adverb) – sleepily, dazedly, drowsily, unsteadily, faintly – कुदरती
41. **Stupefied** (adjective) – stunned, shocked, dazed, bewildered, astonished – चकित
42. **Duo** (noun) – pair, couple, twosome, partners, two people – जोड़ी
43. **Truss up** (phrasal verb) – tie up, bind, secure, restrain, fasten – कसकर बांधना
44. **Thunder** (verb) – boom, roar, shout, bellow, declare loudly – गरजना
45. **Victorious** (adjective) – triumphant, successful, winning, conquering, glorious – विजयी

46. **Gasp** (verb) – pant, breathe heavily, struggle for breath, wheeze, inhale sharply – हांफना / हैरानी से सांस लेना
47. **Amazement** (noun) – surprise, wonder, astonishment, awe, disbelief – आश्चर्य
48. **Scout** (noun) – talent hunter, searcher, recruiter, agent, spotter – खोजी / प्रतिभा खोजने वाला
49. **Secrecy** (noun) – confidentiality, privacy, concealment, coyness, discretion – गोपनीयता
50. **Bald** (adjective) – hairless, smooth, bare, uncovered, shiny-headed – गंजा
51. **Sheepishly** (adverb) – shyly, embarrassedly, awkwardly, bashfully, guiltily – संकोच से
52. **Draw up** (phrasal verb) – prepare, formulate, draft, make, compose – तैयार करना
53. **Courteously** (adverb) – politely, respectfully, civilly, graciously, well-manneredly – विनम्रता से

Practice Exercise



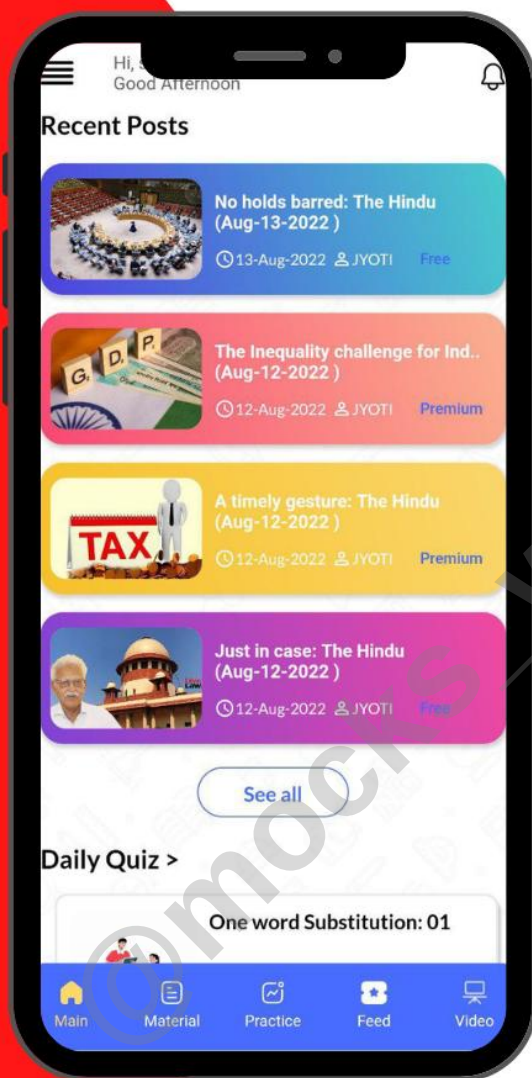
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